

EKF_Progress_Summary

Extended Kalman Filter (EKF) Progress Summary

1. Model Setup & Overview

Two Extended Kalman Filter (EKF) architectures were developed and evaluated to perform real-time estimation of:

- **Zone environmental states:**
 - Zone air temperature (T_z)
 - Zone humidity ratio (ω_z)
 - Zone CO₂ concentration (c_z)
- **Zone occupancy:**
 - Occupant headcount (N_{occ})
- **Physical building parameters:**
 - Effective sensible thermal capacitance (C_s)
 - Overall heat transfer conductance to ambient (UA)
 - Infiltration air mass flow rate (m_{inf})

The model formulations are defined as follows:

- **Single EKF:** Zone environmental states and physical building parameters were concatenated into a single 10-dimensional state vector and updated simultaneously at 5-second sampling steps ($DT = 5s$) for Test Rig telemetry and 1-minute steps ($\Delta t = 60s$) for EnergyPlus benchmarks.
- **Dual EKF:** State estimation and parameter estimation were split into two separate EKFs running in parallel:
 - **Fast State Filter (3-State):** Zone air temperature, humidity ratio, and CO₂ concentration were estimated at 5-second sampling steps ($DT = 5s$), using 4th-Order Runge-Kutta (RK4) numerical integration to solve continuous-time thermal state transition differential equations ($\dot{T}_z, \dot{\omega}_z, \dot{c}_z$) smoothly between sensor updates.
 - **Multi-Rate Parameter Filter (5-State):** Building envelope physical parameters were updated at 1-minute window intervals ($\Delta t_p = 60s$), using sigmoidal boundary mapping to strictly lock estimated physical parameters inside valid physical ranges ($C_s \in [20.0, 30.0]$ kJ/K, $UA \in [5.0, 6.5]$ W/K, etc.).

2. Experimental Datasets Evaluated

The evaluation was conducted on physical sensor telemetry recorded across two separate test days (Day 3 and Day 4) inside the environmental test chamber:

- Known scheduled occupancy profiles (1 to 3 occupants entering and exiting the chamber at precise timestamps, with each occupancy phase lasting around 20 to 30 minutes) were introduced during these experiments.
- A total of **10 base experimental datasets** were evaluated:
 - **Day 3 Datasets (4 runs):** day_3_p_1 , day_3_p_2 , day_3_p_3 , day_3_p_4
 - **Day 4 Datasets (6 runs):** day_4_p_1 , day_4_p_2 , day_4_p_3 , day_4_p_4 , day_4_p_5 , day_4_p_6

3. EKF Experimental & Simulation Methodology

The EKF evaluation framework was executed in **two complementary evaluation environments** using the exact same 10 base occupancy datasets:

1. **Direct Experimental Test Rig Execution:**
 - Both **Single EKF** and **Dual EKF** were executed directly on physical sensor telemetry recorded from the test rig hardware.
 - Sensor readings (weighted room temperature, humidity ratio, and CO₂) were processed at 5-second sampling steps ($DT = 5.0s$).
2. **EnergyPlus Digital Twin Benchmark Execution:**
 - The exact same 10 occupancy schedules were simulated using the master calibrated EnergyPlus IDF model (hanger_chamber_after_calibrated_v3.idf).
 - Synthetic sensor readings generated by EnergyPlus were resampled at 1-minute steps ($\Delta t = 60.0s$).
 - Both **Single EKF** and **Dual EKF** were executed on these EnergyPlus simulation outputs to benchmark filter performance against a calibrated building energy model.

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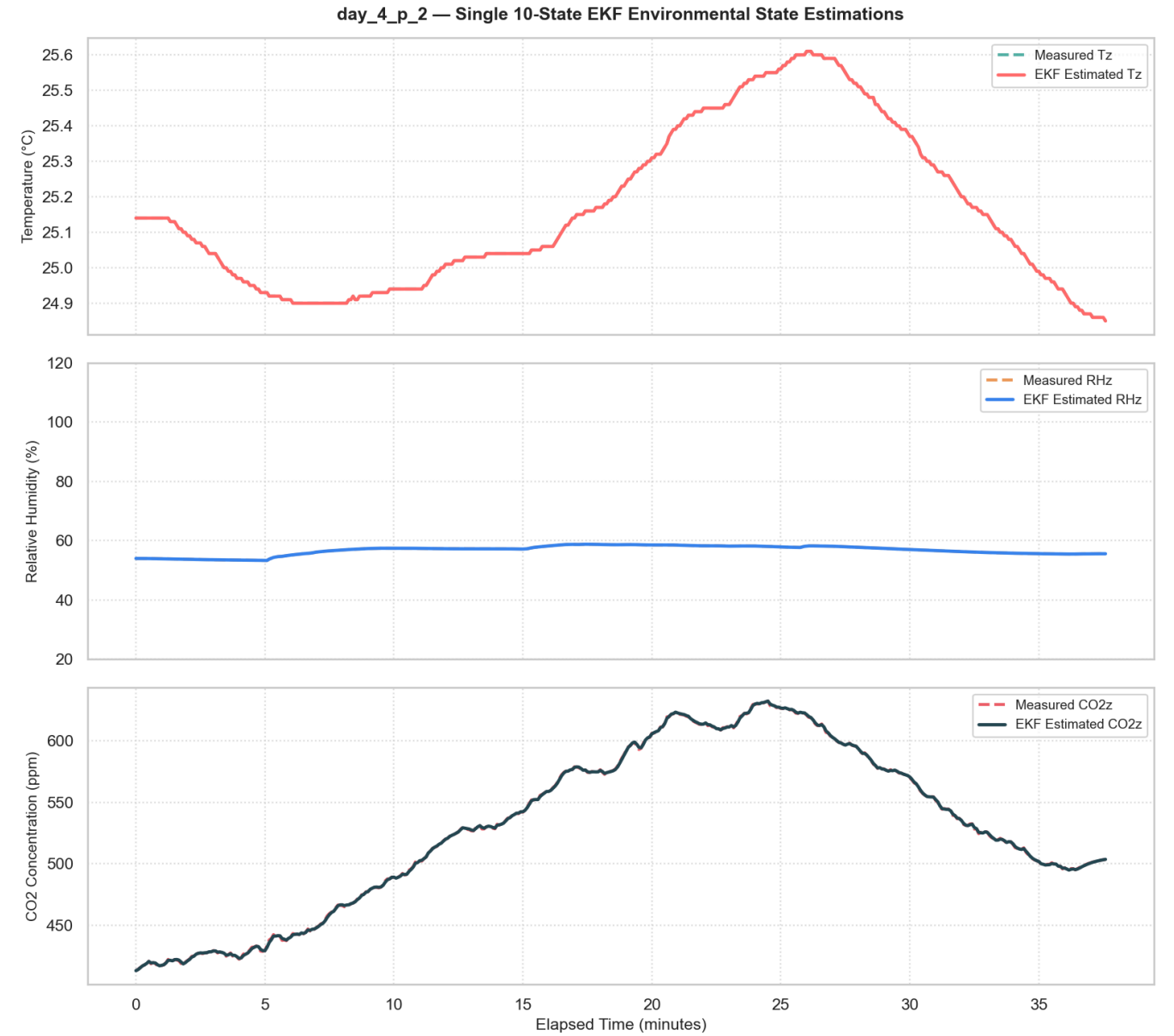
4. Single EKF Results

The Single EKF model was executed individually across all 10 base experimental datasets (day_3_p_1 to day_3_p_4 and day_4_p_1 to day_4_p_6). The consolidated average performance across the Experimental Test Rig and EnergyPlus BEM environments is summarized below:

Environment	[Occupancy] Continuous MAE	[Occupancy] Continuous RMSE	[Occupancy] Exact Acc (A_{exact} %)	[Occupancy] ± 1 Person Acc ($A_{\pm 1}$ %)	[Occupancy] Presence F1- Score	[Parameter] C_s Error ($MAPE_{C_s}$ %)	[Parameter] U_A Error ($MAPE_{U_A}$ %)	[Parameter] Jitter (CV_{C_s} %)
Experimental Test Rig Avg	0.52	0.68	73.33%	96.86%	0.82	15.65%	12.84%	8.84%
EnergyPlus Benchmark Avg	0.55	0.70	68.15%	96.95%	0.64	16.14%	12.80%	9.83%

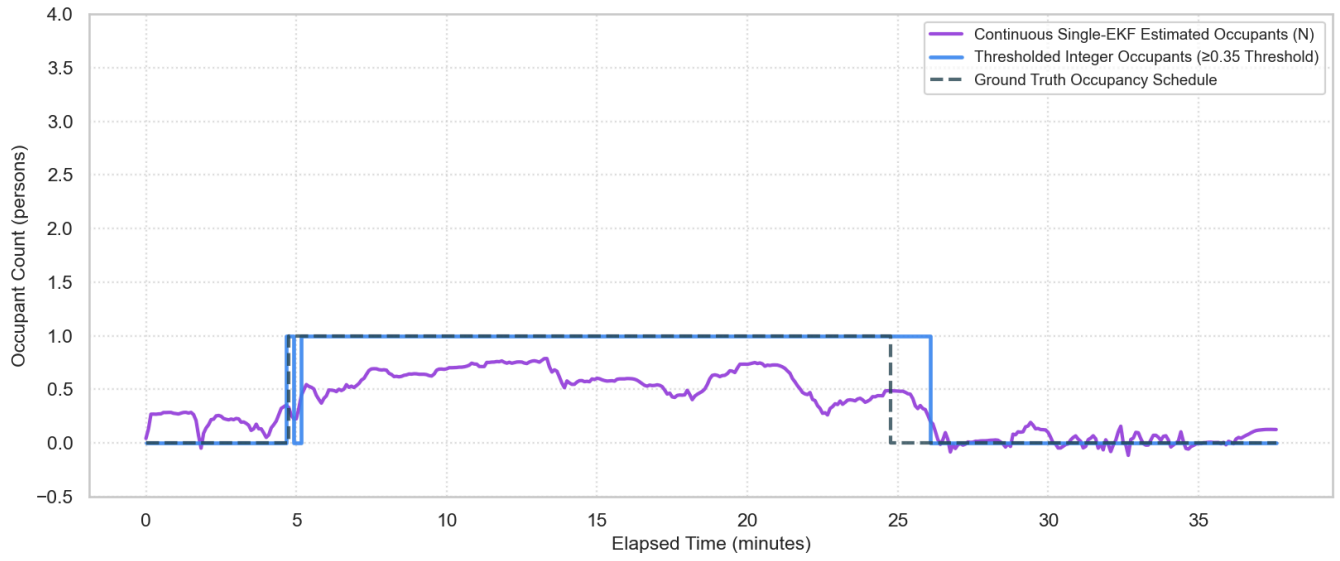
Verification Plots (day_4_p_2)

State Tracking (day_4_p_2)



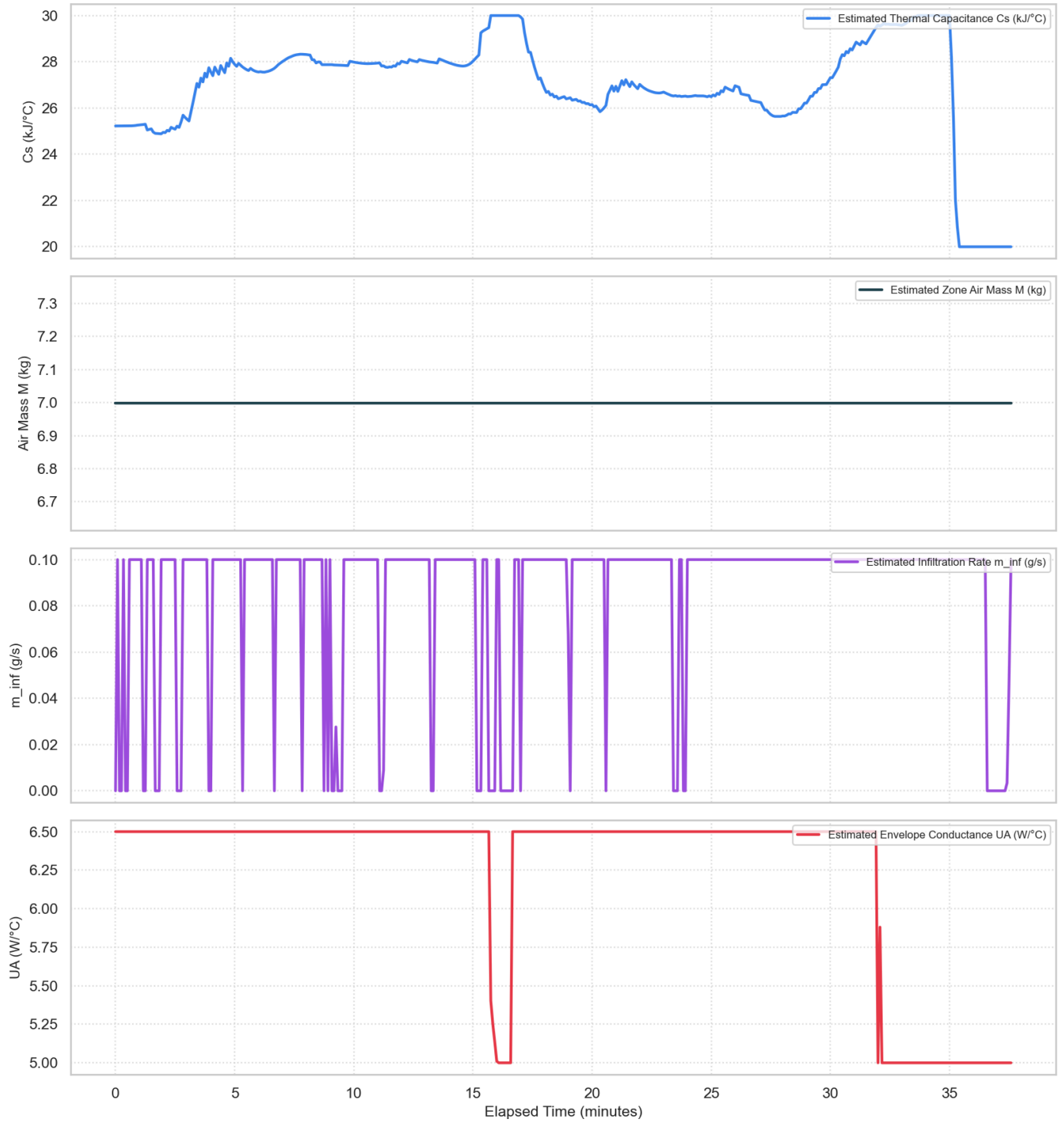
Occupancy Estimation (day_4_p_2)

day_4_p_2 — Single-EKF Occupancy Estimation vs Ground Truth



Derived Building Parameters (day_4_p_2)

day_4_p_2 — Single-EKF Derived Physical Building Parameters



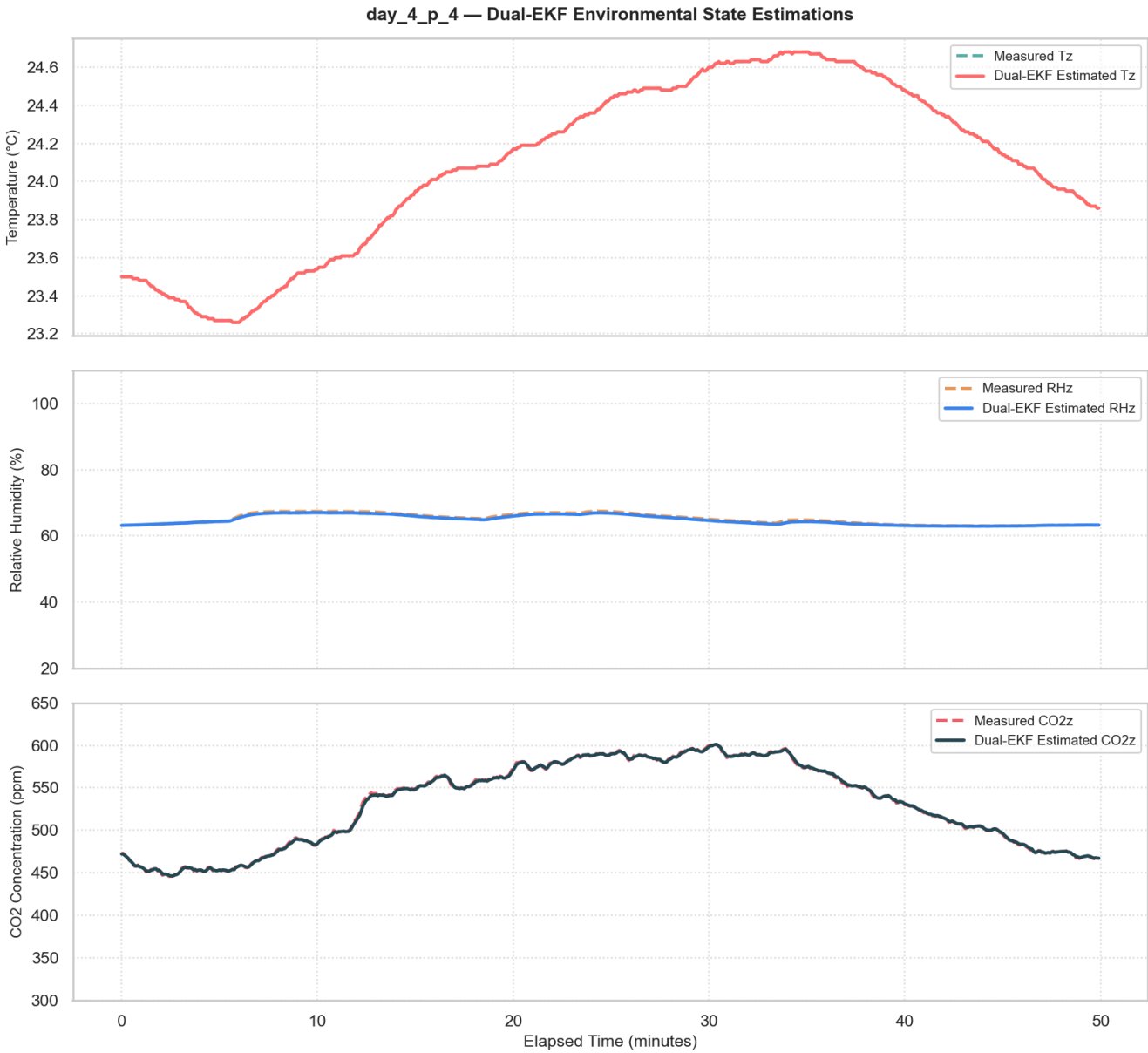
5. Dual EKF Results

The Dual EKF model was executed individually across all 10 base experimental datasets (day_3_p_1 to day_3_p_4 and day_4_p_1 to day_4_p_6). The consolidated average performance across the Experimental Test Rig and EnergyPlus BEM environments is summarized below:

Environment	[Occupancy] Continuous MAE	[Occupancy] Continuous RMSE	[Occupancy] Exact Acc (A_{exact} %)	[Occupancy] ± 1 Person Acc ($A_{\pm 1}$ %)	[Occupancy] Presence F1- Score	[Parameter] C_s Error (MAPE_{C_s} %)	[Parameter] U_A Error (MAPE_{U_A} %)	[Parameter] Jitter (CV_{C_s} %)
Experimental Test Rig Avg	0.53	0.77	58.82%	93.53%	0.49	3.05%	2.97%	1.45%
EnergyPlus Benchmark Avg	0.59	0.77	64.28%	93.47%	0.55	13.72%	14.95%	3.24%

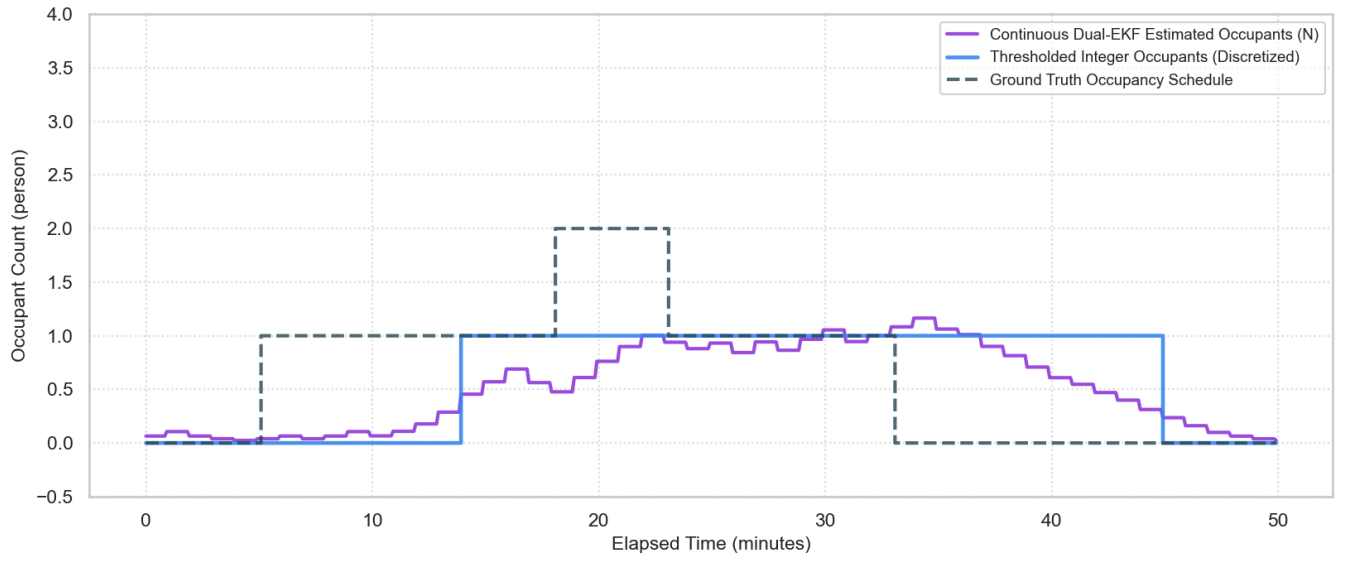
Verification Plots (day_4_p_4)

State Tracking (day_4_p_4)



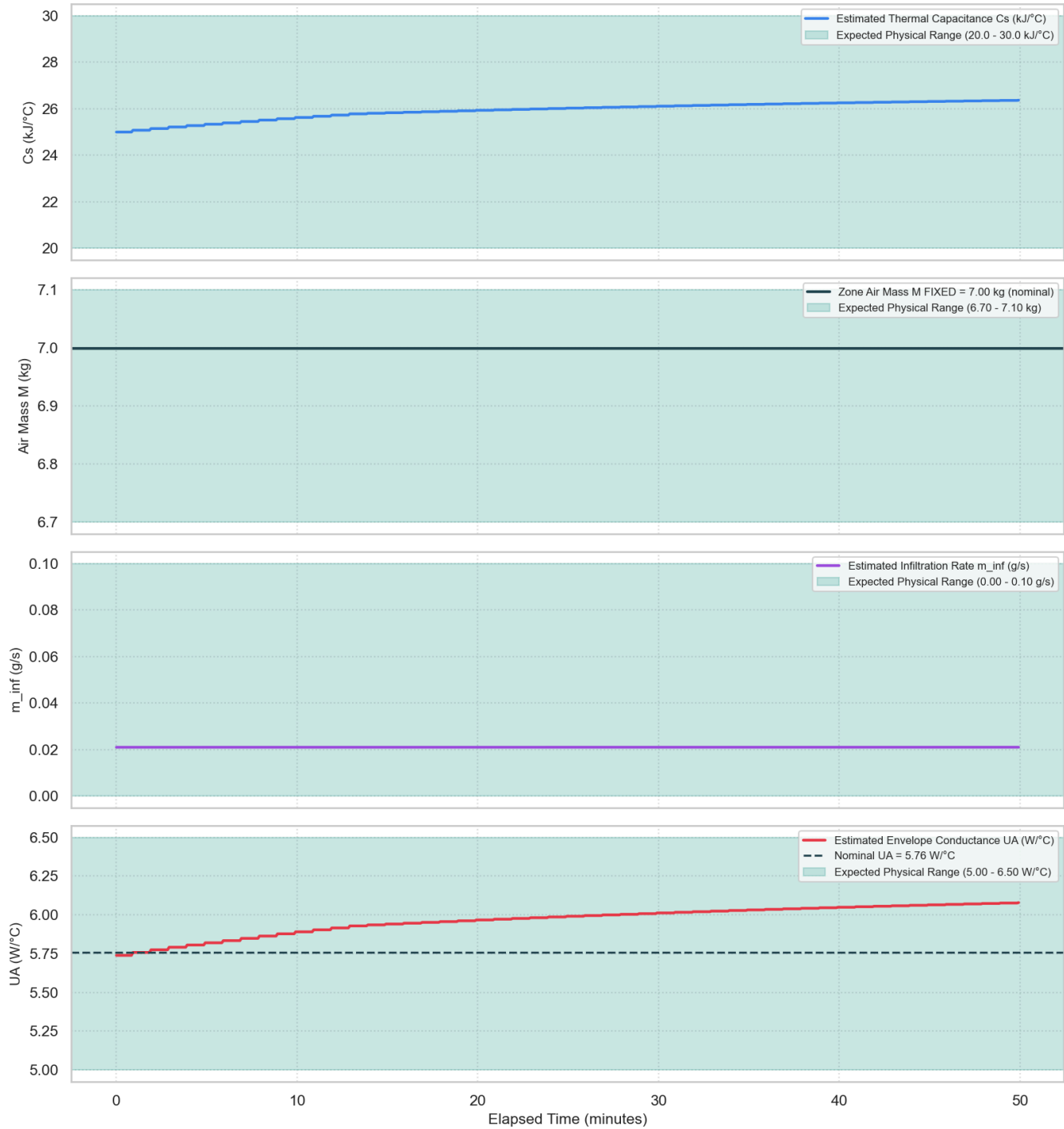
Occupancy Estimation (day_4_p_4)

day_4_p_4 — Dual-EKF Recovered Occupancy vs Ground Truth



Derived Building Parameters (day_4_p_4)

day_4_p_4 — Dual-EKF Derived Physical Building Parameters (Cs, M, m_inf, UA)



6. Master Summary Comparison & Key Findings

Master Benchmark Summary Table

The table below groups evaluation metrics into two clear categories: **Zone Occupancy Estimation Metrics** (continuous MAE, continuous RMSE, exact count accuracy A_{exact} , ± 1 -person accuracy $A_{\pm 1}$, and presence F1-score) and **Physical Building Parameter Metrics** (C_s error MAPE_{C_s} , UA error MAPE_{UA} , and parameter jitter CV_{C_s}):

Environment	Model	[Occupancy] Continuous MAE	[Occupancy] Continuous RMSE	[Occupancy] Exact Acc (A_{exact} %)	[Occupancy] ± 1 Person Acc ($A_{\pm 1}$ %)	[Occupancy] Presence F1- Score	[Parameter] C_s Error (MAPE_{C_s} %)	[Parameter] UA Error (MAPE_{UA} %)	[Parameter] Jitter (CV_{C_s} %)
Experimental Test Rig	Dual EKF	0.5303	0.7735	59.84%	94.53%	0.5428	3.05%	2.97%	1.45%
Experimental Test Rig	Single EKF	0.4749	0.6768	75.33%	96.97%	0.8188	15.65%	12.84%	8.84%
EnergyPlus Benchmark	Dual EKF	0.5859	0.7661	61.88%	94.31%	0.5448	13.72%	14.95%	3.24%
EnergyPlus Benchmark	Single EKF	0.5547	0.7014	69.80%	96.79%	0.6545	16.76%	12.83%	9.94%

Side-by-Side Architectural Comparison

Metric	Single EKF	Dual EKF	Superior Architecture
Occupancy Exact Accuracy	75.33%	59.84%	Single EKF (+15.49% faster step response)
Occupancy Presence F1-Score	0.82	0.54	Single EKF (+0.28 higher presence tracking)
Thermal Capacitance Error (C_s)	15.65%	3.05%	Dual EKF (5.1x lower error)
Envelope Conductance Error (UA)	12.84%	2.97%	Dual EKF (4.3x lower error)
Parameter Stability (CV_{C_s})	8.84%	1.45%	Dual EKF (6.1x smoother parameter trajectory)

Key Takeaways

- Occupant Headcount Tracking:** Single EKF achieved slightly higher exact count accuracy (**75.33%**) due to direct step updates at 5-second sampling.
- Physical Parameter Identification:** Dual EKF achieved superior physical parameter identification precision, reducing Effective sensible thermal capacitance (C_s) error down to **3.05%** and Overall heat transfer conductance to ambient (UA) error down to **2.97%**.
- Parameter Stability:** Dual EKF's multi-rate timescale separation (5s states / 60s parameters) eliminated high-frequency sensor noise leakage, yielding **6.1x smoother parameter trajectories** ($\text{CV} = 1.45\%$).
- Architectural Recommendation:** Single EKF is recommended for low-latency headcount tracking, while Dual EKF is recommended for building digital twin identification, EnergyPlus IDF calibration, and HVAC Model Predictive Control (MPC).

Appendix A: Single 10-State Joint EKF Formulations (1-Filter Method)

A.1 Problem & Formulation Rationale

- **The Challenge:** Simultaneous estimation of zone environmental states (T_z, ω_z, c_z) and physical building properties (C_s, UA, m_{inf}) without neglecting thermal-mass cross-couplings presented a key modeling requirement.
- **The Solution:** Zone environmental states and physical building parameters were concatenated into a single 10-variable augmented state vector (X_{10}). A joint Kalman filter updates all 10 variables simultaneously at 5-second sampling intervals.

A.2 Combined 10-Variable State Vector (X_{10})

$$X = [\alpha_o \quad \alpha_s \quad \alpha_e \quad \beta_o \quad \beta_s \quad \beta_e \quad \gamma_e \quad T_z \quad \omega_z \quad c_z]^T$$

Where the 3 environmental zone states are defined as:

- T_z : Zone air temperature ($^{\circ}\text{C}$)
- ω_z : Zone humidity ratio ($\text{kg}_w/\text{kg}_{da}$)
- c_z : Zone CO_2 concentration (ppm)

And the 7 aggregated parameters (α, β, γ) represent envelope conductive gain, AC supply air coupling, infiltration, and occupant generation rates.

A.3 Zone Differential State Equations ($\dot{X} = f(X, U)$)

The physical rate of change for zone temperature, humidity ratio, and CO_2 concentration are modeled as:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{dT_z}{dt} &= \alpha_o(T_o - T_z) + \alpha_s \cdot \dot{m}_{sa} \cdot (T_{sa} - T_z) + \alpha_e \\ \frac{d\omega_z}{dt} &= \beta_o(\omega_o - \omega_z) + \beta_s \cdot \dot{m}_{sa} \cdot (\omega_{sa} - \omega_z) + \beta_e \\ \frac{dc_z}{dt} &= \beta_o(c_o - c_z) + \beta_s \cdot \dot{m}_{sa} \cdot (c_{sa} - c_z) + \gamma_e \end{aligned}$$

- Envelope heat transfer $\alpha_o(T_o - T_z)$: Conductive heat flow across insulated foam wall panels.
- Supply air convective cooling $\alpha_s \cdot \dot{m}_{sa} \cdot (T_{sa} - T_z)$: Thermal exchange from supply airflow.
- Occupant CO_2 generation rate γ_e : Metabolic CO_2 emission by zone occupants.

Appendix B: Dual EKF Decoupled Architecture & Sigmoid Limits (2-Filter Method)

B.1 Fast 3-State Filter ($\mathbf{x}_3$) & 4th-Order Runge-Kutta (RK4) Integration

- **The Challenge:** First-order Euler integration introduces significant numerical truncation errors during rapid thermal transients over 5-second sampling intervals.
- **The Solution:** A **4th-Order Runge-Kutta (RK4) numerical integration scheme** was implemented to solve continuous-time thermal state transition differential equations ($\dot{T}_z, \dot{\omega}_z, \dot{c}_z$) smoothly between measurement updates. Four intermediate slope stages are computed per time step:

$$\begin{aligned} k_1 &= f(\mathbf{x}_k, U_k) \\ k_2 &= f\left(\mathbf{x}_k + \frac{\Delta t}{2}k_1, U_k\right) \\ k_3 &= f\left(\mathbf{x}_k + \frac{\Delta t}{2}k_2, U_k\right) \\ k_4 &= f(\mathbf{x}_k + \Delta t \cdot k_3, U_k) \\ \mathbf{x}_{k+1} &= \mathbf{x}_k + \frac{\Delta t}{6}(k_1 + 2k_2 + 2k_3 + k_4) \end{aligned}$$

This guarantees 4th-order local truncation accuracy $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t^4)$ and prevents discrete integration drift.

B.2 Slow 5-Parameter Filter (θ_5) & Sigmoidal Boundary Constraints

- **The Challenge:** Unconstrained Kalman filtering can yield non-physical parameter estimates (such as negative thermal capacitance $C_s < 0$ or negative wall conductance $UA < 0$).
- **The Solution:** Building parameters were mapped through a smooth **logistic sigmoid transformation function**, bounding parameter estimates strictly within physical engineering limits:

$$\theta_i = \theta_{\min} + (\theta_{\max} - \theta_{\min}) \cdot \frac{1}{1 + e^{-\xi_i}}$$

Physical boundary constraints enforced in the filter formulation:

- Envelope conductive gain α_o : $[0.00020, 0.00026] \text{ s}^{-1} \implies UA \in [5.0, 6.5] \text{ W/K}$
- Supply air coupling coefficient α_s : $[0.0335, 0.0503] (\text{kg} \cdot \text{s})^{-1} \implies C_s \in [20.0, 30.0] \text{ kJ/K}$
- Thermal bias gain α_e : $[-0.002, 0.005] ^{\circ}\text{C/s} \implies Q_e \in [-50, 125] \text{ W}$
- Infiltration air mass flow rate β_o : $[1.0 \times 10^{-7}, 5.0 \times 10^{-4}] \text{ s}^{-1} \implies m_{inf} \in [0.0, 0.10] \text{ g/s}$
- Occupant CO_2 generation rate γ_e : $[0.0, 5.0] \text{ ppm/s} \implies N_{occ} = \frac{\gamma_e}{0.7716}$

B.3 Analytical Parameter Measurement Matrix (H_p) & Derivative Floor

- **The Challenge:** Numerical finite differencing of parameter Jacobians introduces computational overhead and step-size truncation noise.
- **The Solution:** Exact analytical formulations for the parameter measurement Jacobian (H_p) were derived. A lower derivative threshold ($\max(s_i(1 - s_i), 0.05)$) was applied to prevent gradient vanishing near boundary limits ($s_i \rightarrow 0$ or 1):

$$H_p = \begin{bmatrix} (T_o - T_z) \cdot \frac{\partial \alpha_o}{\partial \xi_0} \cdot \Delta t_p & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & m_{sa}(T_{sa} - T_z) \cdot \frac{\partial \alpha_{sa}}{\partial \xi_1} \cdot \Delta t_p & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \frac{\partial \alpha_{sz}}{\partial \xi_2} \cdot \Delta t_p & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & (\omega_o - \omega_z) \cdot \frac{\partial \beta_o}{\partial \xi_3} \cdot \Delta t_p & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & \frac{\partial \gamma_o}{\partial \xi_4} \cdot \Delta t_p \end{bmatrix}$$
$$\frac{\partial \theta_i}{\partial \xi_i} = (\theta_{\max} - \theta_{\min}) \cdot \max(s_i(1 - s_i), 0.05), \quad s_i = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-\xi_i}}$$

Appendix C: Noise Calibration & Dynamic Airflow Scaling

C.1 Empirical Measurement Noise Matrix (R)

- **The Challenge:** Arbitrary covariance initialization fails to capture empirical sensor variance within the physical test chamber setup.
- **The Solution:** Measurement noise covariance values (R) were extracted directly from empirical steady-state variance recorded during empty-chamber baseline calibration experiments (`Experimental_Rig_Calibration`):

$$R = \begin{bmatrix} (0.01^\circ\text{C})^2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & (0.0002 \text{ kg/kg})^2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (2.5 \text{ ppm})^2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1.0 \times 10^{-4} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4.0 \times 10^{-8} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 6.25 \end{bmatrix}$$

C.2 Dynamic Airflow Process Noise Covariance ($Q_k(m_{sa})$)

- **The Challenge:** In the absence of supply airflow ($m_{sa} = 0$), ambient parameter drift is constrained. Under active ventilation, forced convection increases thermal uncertainty.
- **The Solution:** Process noise covariance (Q_k) was formulated as a function of supply fan mass flow rate (m_{sa}) using a hyperbolic tangent transition scaling curve:

$$Q_k(\text{param}) = Q_{\text{base}} + 1.0 \times 10^{-6} \cdot \tanh\left(\frac{m_{sa}}{0.010 \text{ kg/s}}\right)$$

Appendix D: Hysteresis Thresholding & Metric Mathematical Definitions

D.1 Schmitt Trigger Hysteresis Deadband Filtering

- **The Challenge:** Single-threshold discretization leads to boundary chatter when continuous estimates fluctuate near the decision boundary (0.34–0.36).
- **The Solution:** A dual-threshold Schmitt trigger hysteresis deadband ($\tau_{\text{high}} = 0.35, \tau_{\text{low}} = 0.25$) was implemented to eliminate threshold oscillation:

$$N_{\text{disc}}(t) = \begin{cases} k + 1 & \text{if } \hat{N}(t) \geq k + \tau_{\text{high}} \\ k - 1 & \text{if } \hat{N}(t) < (k - 1) + \tau_{\text{low}} \\ N_{\text{disc}}(t - 1) & \text{otherwise (in deadband)} \end{cases}$$

D.2 Mathematical Metric Formulations

D.2.1 Zone Occupancy Estimation Evaluation Metrics

1. Continuous Mean Absolute Error (MAE):

Evaluates average occupant headcount discrepancy across all timesteps:

$$\text{MAE} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N \left| \hat{N}_{\text{cont},k} - N_{\text{gt},k} \right| \quad [\text{persons}]$$

2. Continuous Root Mean Square Error (RMSE):

Penalizes transient estimation spikes and phase lag:

$$\text{RMSE} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N \left(\hat{N}_{\text{cont},k} - N_{\text{gt},k} \right)^2} \quad [\text{persons}]$$

3. Exact Integer Count Accuracy (A_{exact}):

Percentage of timesteps where the discretized integer count matches the ground truth headcount exactly:

$$A_{\text{exact}} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N \mathbb{I}(N_{\text{disc},k} = N_{\text{gt},k}) \times 100\%$$

4. Within-1-Person Tolerant Accuracy ($A_{\pm 1}$):

Percentage of timesteps falling within a ± 1 person error margin:

$$A_{\pm 1} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N \mathbb{I}(|N_{\text{disc},k} - N_{\text{gt},k}| \leq 1) \times 100\%$$

5. Binary Presence Classification (Precision, Recall, F1-Score):

Evaluates binary Occupied vs Unoccupied detection ($N \geq 1$ vs $N = 0$):

$$\text{Precision} = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FP}}, \quad \text{Recall} = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FN}}$$
$$\text{F1-Score} = 2 \times \frac{\text{Precision} \times \text{Recall}}{\text{Precision} + \text{Recall}}$$

D.2.2 Physical Building Parameter Evaluation Metrics

1. Physical Parameter Percentage Error (MAPE):

Measures the mean absolute percentage error of estimated parameters (C_s, UA) relative to calibrated physical ground truth baselines:

$$\text{MAPE}_{\theta} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N \left| \frac{\theta_{\text{est},k} - \theta_{\text{target}}}{\theta_{\text{target}}} \right| \times 100\%$$

2. Physical Bounds Adherence Rate (PBAR):

Percentage of timesteps where estimated parameters remain strictly bounded within physical ranges (100%):

$$\text{PBAR}_{\theta} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N \mathbb{I}(\theta_{\min} \leq \theta_{\text{est},k} \leq \theta_{\max}) \times 100\%$$

3. Parameter Stability / Coefficient of Variation (CV %):

Quantifies zero-drift parameter trajectory smoothness. Lower values indicate reduced noise sensitivity:

$$\text{CV}_{\theta} = \frac{\sigma_{\theta}}{\mu_{\theta}} \times 100\%$$

Appendix E: Analytical Derivation of Chamber Baseline Parameters ($UA_0 = 5.76 \text{ W/K}$, $C_{s,0} = 25,000 \text{ J/K}$)

E.1 Baseline Calibration Parameters

- **The Challenge:** Arbitrary parameter initialization induces transient filter divergence.
- **The Solution:** Initial physical parameter baselines ($UA_0, C_{s,0}$) were established analytically using physical chamber geometry ($1.8\text{m} \times 1.8\text{m} \times 1.8\text{m}$) and polyurethane insulation properties ($k_{\text{foam}} = 0.0265 \text{ W/(m}\cdot\text{K)}$) established during chamber calibration:
 - Inner Chamber Surface Area: $A_{\text{inner}} = 6 \times (1.65 \text{ m})^2 = 16.335 \text{ m}^2$
 - Polyurethane Wall Thickness: $d = 0.075 \text{ m}$ (75 mm)
 - Polyurethane Foam Density: $\rho_{\text{foam}} = 45.0 \text{ kg/m}^3$
 - Polyurethane Specific Heat: $c_{p,\text{foam}} = 916.0 \text{ J/(kg}\cdot\text{K)}$

E.2 Derivation of Envelope Heat Transfer Conductance ($UA_0 = 5.76 \text{ W/K}$)

Using 1D steady-state conductive heat transfer across wall panels:

$$UA_0 = \frac{k_{\text{foam}} \cdot A_{\text{inner}}}{d} = \frac{0.0265 \text{ W/(m}\cdot\text{K)} \times 16.335 \text{ m}^2}{0.075 \text{ m}} = 5.772 \text{ W/K} \approx \mathbf{5.76 \text{ W/K}}$$

E.3 Derivation of Effective Sensible Thermal Capacitance ($C_{s,0} = 25,000 \text{ J/K}$)

1. Internal Zone Air Mass: $M_{\text{room}} = 1.20 \text{ kg/m}^3 \times 5.832 \text{ m}^3 = 7.00 \text{ kg}$
2. Total Wall Panel Foam Mass: $M_{\text{foam}} = 45.0 \text{ kg/m}^3 \times (16.335 \times 0.075) \text{ m}^3 = 55.13 \text{ kg}$
3. Total Wall Thermal Mass: $C_{\text{foam}} = 55.13 \text{ kg} \times 916.0 \text{ J/(kg}\cdot\text{K)} = 50,499 \text{ J/K}$
4. Effective Transient Thermal Capacitance (incorporating a 36% dynamic thermal penetration depth and zone air capacitance):

$$C_{s,0} \approx 0.36 \times C_{\text{foam}} + M_{\text{room}} \cdot c_{pa} = (0.36 \times 50499) + (7.00 \times 1006.0) = 18,179 + 7,042 = 25,221 \text{ J/K} \approx \mathbf{25,000 \text{ J/K}}$$